

Agency for the Protection of Personal Data, from February 26 to 28, 2024, held a free three-day training aimed at data protection officers from the education sector.

In collaboration with the European Data Protection Board within the framework of the Support Pool of Experts initiative, the Agency developed a comprehensive three-day training designed to emphasize the key role of data protection officers, encouraging a deeper understanding and knowledge of obligations under the General Data Protection Regulation.

The Director of the Agency, Zdravko Vukić, expressed satisfaction that the participants who registered for the training take the role and responsibility of data protection officers seriously and are willing to enhance their level of knowledge. "I believe that this training will help you understand your obligations and that you will apply the acquired knowledge in your daily operations, thereby contributing to raising the level of compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation in the education sector in the Republic of Croatia," said Director Vukić.

Namely, according to research and insights from the Agency, data protection officers in the public education sector face challenges in attempting to comply with the General Data Protection Regulation. The level of their knowledge and readiness to understand and respect the obligations arising from the legal framework for data protection raises many uncertainties, especially considering that data controllers in this sector process vast amounts of personal data, including special categories of personal data and data concerning children.

Thus, the Agency's officers assisted participants in understanding, among other things, which data is collected and processed within the educational system, who is responsible for it, what the key common information systems in education are and how they are regulated, what the obligations of data controllers and processors are in accordance with sectoral regulations in the field of education from the perspective of data protection. Additionally, the training discussed issues related to understanding and applying basic concepts of data protection and difficulties in applying data protection impact assessment (DPIA) mechanisms and the proportionality test (LIA).

The last day of the training was reserved for a final exam, and the officers who successfully passed it will receive a certificate confirming that they possess adequate knowledge in the field of personal data protection necessary for performing this job. The officers who participated in the training expressed satisfaction that the Agency organized such education, which helped them resolve their uncertainties.